

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Ferhat Uddin

Address: 12 Garbrand walk Ewell KT17 1UQ

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: A dedicated community centre for the Muslim community is not just a building - it is an essential investment in wellbeing, inclusion, and equity.

As a women's health clinician, I work closely with the South Asian community in closing health inequalities. Through my clinical practice, I have seen firsthand how deeply social determinants of health - isolation, language barriers, stigma, and lack of culturally appropriate services - affect outcomes, particularly for women. Many women from ethnic minority backgrounds struggle to have their voices heard. Cultural expectations, limited safe spaces, and fear of judgement can prevent them from seeking support, speaking openly about health concerns, or accessing mainstream services.

A community centre would provide a trusted, culturally sensitive environment where individuals and families feel safe, understood, and respected. For women especially, access to a secure and welcoming space can be transformative. It creates opportunities for:

- Health education and prevention programmes, delivered in culturally appropriate ways
- Women-only sessions where sensitive topics such as reproductive health, mental wellbeing, domestic abuse, and menopause can be discussed openly
- Peer support networks that reduce isolation and build confidence
- Youth engagement initiatives that promote positive identity and belonging
- Intergenerational activities that strengthen family and community cohesion

From my professional experience, safe and open spaces are vital for empowering women to advocate for themselves and their families. When women feel heard and supported, the benefits

ripple outward - improving child health, family wellbeing, and overall community resilience.

A community centre would also act as a bridge between statutory services and the community, helping to build trust where mistrust or misunderstanding may exist. By hosting outreach clinics, workshops, and partnership initiatives, it could directly contribute to reducing health inequalities and improving access to care.

I believe the community centre would become a cornerstone for empowerment, wellbeing, and social connection - a space where cultural identity is celebrated, voices are amplified, and barriers to health and opportunity are actively dismantled.